

Movie Show Investing — Full MVP Recap

Filmmaker and investor sides · Q4 2026 demand tests · movieshowinvesting.com · Updated September 27, 2026

Overview

Movie Show Investing runs stealth demand tests on movieshowinvesting.com in Q4 2026 (October to December). The goal: prove filmmakers want investors instead of crowdfunding rewards, and investors will pledge to movies and shows.

- Movie Show Investing is the filmmaker-investor matching platform. It collects non-binding pledges; no trades happen here. The AYeList is the investment and distribution platform.
- Owned by AYe Producer, Inc. and run outside The AYeList, with no Greenlights.
- Modeled on Wefunder's petition: collect non-binding pledges, then take the totals to boutique investment firms and distributors as proof.
- No money moves. Every pledge is non-binding.
- One small site (React + Flask on Replit, Bunny for media, Mailjet for email, Firebase Auth for sign-in links and phone checks), marketed for three months.
- Frameworks: Disciplined Entrepreneurship Steps 15-16 and 20-23; The Lean Startup; The Right It; Testing Business Ideas; The Mom Test.

The test loop



Filmmaker and investor share cards both loop new people back to project pages, which feeds more pledges into the admin data you pitch with.

The six tests

Four tests run on the site; two are outreach using the site's data. Pass lines for each test are set before launch.

Test	Hypothesis	Where it runs	Strongest evidence
1. Filmmakers	Filmmakers will submit projects to raise from investors instead of rewards crowdfunding	Filmmaker flow	Submission with a trailer or pilot link; a booked chat
2. Retail investors	Everyday investors will pledge \$100 or more	Investor flow	Confirmed non-binding pledge
3. Accredited investors	Accredited investors will pledge larger amounts or book a call	Investor flow	Booked one-on-one briefing
4. Boutique investment firms	Firms will take meetings once they see the pledge data	Your outreach	Meeting or letter of intent
5. Distributors	Distributors will want to see demand data per project	Your outreach	Request for the data or a call

Test	Hypothesis	Where it runs	Strongest evidence
6. Business model	Filmmaker offers and investor minimums overlap, leaving room for the platform fee	Filmmaker Screens 3-4, investor Page 2	Offers vs. minimums by slate; price-test completion rates

Marketplace and pricing

Movie Show Investing is a two-sided marketplace: each filmmaker sets an offer to investors, each investor sets minimum terms, and projects that meet an investor's terms are marked as matches. The platform earns a fixed fee per slate on top of the offer, shown openly to filmmakers.

Slate	Project stage	Default offer to investors (per \$100)	Platform fee	Filmmaker pays back at default	After payback, filmmaker keeps
Distribution	Looking for distribution or already distributed	\$125	\$25	\$150	\$67 of every \$100
Production	Short or pilot to develop	\$150	\$20	\$170	\$60 of every \$100
Idea	Script or idea	\$175	\$15	\$190	All of it

- **Floor:** investors are never offered less than \$125 per \$100. Filmmakers can keep the default or offer \$150, \$175, \$200, or another amount at or above \$125.
- **Wanting lower:** "I'd need to offer less than \$125" is saved as pricing data; the project lists at \$125.
- **A rate, not an amount:** the offer scales to any pledge. At \$150 per \$100, a \$40 pledge shows a \$60 payback goal and a \$1,000 pledge shows \$1,500.
- **During payback:** 100% of earnings go to investors until paid back in full, with no deadline. Shown to filmmakers only; the investor side never states payment order.
- **Stays in the slate documents, not on test pages:** the flip at 2.0x and the 3.0x cap.
- **Price test:** on Distribution, half of filmmakers see a \$15 fee instead of \$25.
- **Market figures:** filmmakers see "Most investors here look for at least \$X per \$100"; investors see "Filmmakers typically offer \$X" on the matches page only. Both appear once 20+ people have answered.
- **Idea Slate sizes:** \$50K feature, \$65K series (to confirm).
- **Later:** better rates for bigger pledges, once pledge sizes are known.

Example budgets at the default offer

Slate	Example raise	Investors get	Platform fee	Filmmaker pays back
Distribution	\$25,000	\$31,250	\$6,250	\$37,500
Distribution	\$50,000	\$62,500	\$12,500	\$75,000
Distribution	\$100,000	\$125,000	\$25,000	\$150,000
Production (feature)	\$200,000	\$300,000	\$40,000	\$340,000
Production (6-episode series)	\$350,000	\$525,000	\$70,000	\$595,000
Production (8-episode series)	\$450,000	\$675,000	\$90,000	\$765,000
Idea (feature)	\$50,000	\$87,500	\$7,500	\$95,000
Idea (series)	\$65,000	\$113,750	\$9,750	\$123,500

Shared ladder (per \$100)

\$125 • \$150 • \$175 • \$200 • \$250+ • Other

- Filmmakers pick their offer to investors from this ladder.
- Investors pick the least they'd need back for each slate type, with "Not interested" also available.
- The market works for a slate when filmmaker offers and investor minimums overlap.

Filmmaker side

Six screens, about 60–90 seconds, one question per screen with a progress bar. The slate picked on Screen 1 carries through every screen.

How they arrive

- From a UGC video, an Instagram, LinkedIn or Reddit post, a Google ad, or another filmmaker's share link. Every link is tagged by channel.
- **Home page:** one headline ("Fund your next film with investors, not T-shirts"), two buttons ("I'm a filmmaker" and "I want to invest"), and a real counter.

Screen 1: Where's your project at?

- Distribution phase (looking for distribution, or already distributed) → Distribution Slate
- Short or pilot I want to develop → Production Slate
- Script or idea → Idea Slate
- Other (text box)

Screen 2: Your project

- Title, movie or show (toggle), genre chips plus Other, logline
- Trailer link (optional); short/pilot link (optional, shown only for "Short or pilot")
- Checkbox: "I don't have a project yet. I want to participate in the future." Checking it skips to Screen 6.

Screen 3: Your deal

- Two tabs, **Example budget** and **Your budget** (live calculator), shared with Screen 4. Their own number is required to continue; any amount is accepted.
- Receipt at the standard offer: you raise, investors get back, platform fee, you pay back, and what they keep after.
- **"Would you take this deal?"** Yes, I'd take it · Maybe, if I could negotiate · No, not at these terms. Yes preselects the standard offer on Screen 4; Maybe and No open Screen 4 ready to propose.

Screen 4: Your offer to investors

YOUR OFFER TO INVESTORS · NIGHT SHIFT
Standard for Distribution: \$125 per \$100

Offer investors, for every \$100:
[•\$125] [\$150] [\$175] [\$200] [Other]
☐ I'd need to offer less than \$125

On your \$80,000 raise:

Investors get back	\$100,000
Platform fee	\$20,000
YOU PAY BACK	\$120,000

PHASE 1 Until \$120,000 is paid back, earnings go to investors
PHASE 2 After that: YOU KEEP \$67 OF EVERY \$100

Most investors here look for at least \$150 per \$100.
(shown once 20+ investors have answered)

- Offers start at \$125; Other must be \$125 or more. "Less than \$125" is saved as data and the project lists at \$125.
- The offer shows on their project page and Explore card.
- **How payback works:** "If your film earns \$10,000 a month, all of it goes to investors until \$120,000 is paid back, about 12 months. After that, you keep \$6,700 of every \$10,000." Works for me · I need some from day one · Other.

Screen 5: How did you finance your last project?

- Pick any: own money · friends and family · Kickstarter / Indiegogo / Seed&Spark · grants · investors · studios · haven't yet · Other
- Then: Did you reach your goal? Yes / No, and "What was your experience?"

Screen 6: Almost done

- Name, email, phone (optional), city, state, favorite genres
- Checkbox: open to a 15-minute chat (Calendly link in the confirmation email)

After the flow

- **Result screen:** "NIGHT SHIFT fits the Distribution Slate" with their numbers at their offer.
- **Share card:** "I want investors, not crowdfunding rewards." plus title, genre and slate. No dollar amounts. Links to their private project page.
- **Showcase screen:** "Put NIGHT SHIFT in front of investors." Yes, showcase it · Keep it private for now. Optional **Strengthen your page** fields: synopsis, team and credit links, what the money pays for, distribution plan, trailer and poster uploads.
- **Verification:** email verified by the confirmation link; phone verified by a text code (Firebase). Each earns a badge.
- **Confirmation email:** slate, offer, numbers, share link, a sign-in link to their private page, and the Calendly link if they asked for a chat.
- **Private filmmaker page:** project, numbers, share card, status, referral count, and investor questions waiting for an answer.

Project pages, Explore, and trust

Every filmmaker submission gets one project page, used two ways.

- **Private (default):** unlisted, seen only by people with the link. The filmmaker's share card points here.
- **Public (opt-in):** the same page also appears on Explore after the filmmaker taps "Yes, showcase it" and you approve it in admin.

Securities notice (top of Explore and every project page)

"Pledge your interest in future investment opportunities. If a project opens for investment, it will be offered only in compliance with securities laws, and you'll get full offering documents before you decide."

Explore card

```
[ poster ]  
NIGHT SHIFT · Horror · Movie · Finished film  
✓ Email verified ✓ Phone verified  
"A night nurse discovers her patients aren't dying..."  
Raising: $50,000  
Payback goal: $150 for every $100 (this filmmaker's offer)  
Returns aren't guaranteed. You may get back less, or nothing.  
★ Matches your terms  
$4,300 pledged by 27 people (confirmed pledges only)  
[ Add to my lineup ]
```

- **Filters and sorting:** slate type, genre, movie or show, raise size, and payback goal.
- **Match badge:** only when the project's offer meets that investor's minimum for its slate type and fits their interests.
- **Top of page:** Auto-build my lineup · Just pledge an amount · Find my lineup (in the header).

Project page

- Video, title, logline, genre, slate type, movie or show, verified badges
- Raise goal, the project's payback goal per \$100, and the one-line disclaimer
- Confirmed pledge count
- Strengthen-your-page fields when provided: synopsis, team and credits links, what the money pays for, distribution plan
- Full disclaimer: "Returns aren't guaranteed. If a project earns less than expected, you may get back less than you put in, or nothing. Payback goals may change."
- "How the money flows" (no payment order stated) and "Where the money comes from" (streaming rentals and purchases: Live; outside distributors and streamers: In progress; screenings, events, and merch: In progress)
- Buttons: **I'm interested** (opens the investor flow with this project in the lineup) and **Ask the filmmaker**

Trust features in version one

Feature	How it works	Why
Richer project page	Optional fields on the Showcase screen	Shows who's behind the project and how it pays back
Ask the filmmaker	Investor asks on the project page → filmmaker gets an email with a private answer link → answer is emailed to the investor. No emails exchanged. 5 questions per investor per day.	Real two-way contact with little moderation
Verified badges	Email confirmation click; phone text code (Firebase)	Deters fakes; visible at a glance
Live project sessions	Filmmaker hosts a 20-minute Google Meet via Calendly	No build; run manually

- Every message is stored and visible in admin, with a hide button and a report link in every email. The form says: "Messages are stored and may be reviewed by Movie Show Investing for safety."
- **Idea protection:** loglines and synopses only, never full scripts; every submission is timestamped; the FAQ suggests registering scripts with the U.S. Copyright Office or the WGA registry.
- **Later:** public Q&A, direct messages, filmmaker updates.

Investor side

Five pages: preferences first, then matches, then the pledge. A lineup bar is pinned once projects are picked.

Rules everywhere

- **Payback goals** come from each project's offer. Always a sentence: "Payback goal: \$150 for every \$100." After a pledge, in their dollars: "Payback goal: \$60 back on your \$40."
- **Never say:** return, earn, expected, realistic, or who gets paid first. The AYeList is named only in the FAQ.
- **Next to every number:** "Returns aren't guaranteed. You may get back less, or nothing."
- **Limits:** \$100 minimum total; \$25 minimum per project; up to 4 projects under \$150, up to 5 at \$150+. One lineup per email.
- **Footer:** "Pledges are non-binding. No money is collected. This is not an offer to sell securities."

Page 1: Your amount

[\$100] [\$500] [\$1,000] [\$10,000] [Other] — \$100 minimum. If they started from a project page, that project is already in their lineup.

Page 2: Your terms

The least you'd need back for every \$100 you put in:
Finished film (Distribution)
[\$125] [\$150] [\$175] [\$200] [\$250+] [Other] [Not interested]
Short or pilot to develop (Production)
[\$125] [\$150] [\$175] [\$200] [\$250+] [Other] [Not interested]
Script or idea (Idea)
[\$125] [\$150] [\$175] [\$200] [\$250+] [Other] [Not interested]

- Plus: Fixed payback, no upside (lender) · Payback plus a share of the profits (investor) · Either · Not sure · Why? (optional)
- Nothing preselected; no offers or market figures shown on this page, to avoid anchoring.

Page 3: Your interests

- Genres (chips), stages, motivations (returns · supporting indie filmmakers · spreading risk / alternative investments · perks like premieres or credits · Other)
- "What would make you feel safe investing in movies and shows?"

Page 4: Your matches

- Explore, filtered to their interests, with "Matches your terms" badges; "Filmmakers typically offer \$X" shown here (once 20+ offers exist).
- They pick projects; the amount **splits equally** by default (e.g., \$500 across 5 = \$100 each, whole dollars, remainder to the first), editable within the limits.
- **Auto-build** picks matching projects across slate types, then genres. **Just pledge** saves an unallocated pledge.

MY LINEUP: \$500 across 5 projects
Mix: 2 Distribution · 2 Production · 1 Idea
Spread: ●●●● Fully spread
Payback goal if every project pays back in full: \$725
You may get back less, or nothing.

Spread rating	What it takes
●○○○ All in one	1 project
●●○○ A little spread	2-3 projects, or all in one slate type
●●●○ Well spread	4-5 projects across 2 slate types
●●●● Fully spread	4-5 projects across all 3 slate types

Page 5: About you

- Name, email, phone (optional), city, state, zip
- Accredited investor? Yes · No · Not sure, with the plain definition
- Investing experience; open to a call (accredited: 30-minute one-on-one briefing, priority; retail: weekly group Q&A)
- **Signed non-binding indication of interest:** typed full name, timestamped, plus the required acknowledgment: "I understand this pledge is non-binding, no money is collected, and returns aren't guaranteed."
- Existing email: "You already have a lineup. We've sent you the link."

After the flow

- **Result:** "Your lineup is in," each project with amount and payback goal, the share card, and the referral count.
- **Share card:** "I've pledged to invest in NIGHT SHIFT when it opens. A pledge from you would go a long way." Amount toggle off by default.
- **Pledge confirmation email (non-binding):** a **Confirm my pledge** button, a copy of the signed indication of interest, the securities notice, a sign-in link to their lineup, and the right Calendly link. Only confirmed pledges count publicly.
- **Private lineup page:** view-only; pledges fixed; project totals and referral count update live; no personal details shown.
- **Access:** Firebase email-link sign-in from the email or from **Find my lineup** (same message for every email; 3 requests per email per hour).

FAQ

1. **What is Movie Show Investing?** A platform where filmmakers share projects and investors pledge interest, so both sides can find each other before investment opens.
2. **Is my pledge an investment?** No. No trades happen here and no money is collected. A pledge is a non-binding indication of interest. If a project opens for investment, you'll be invited to decide then.
3. **How will money flow when investment opens?** The flow graphic, with no payment order stated.
4. **Who's the distribution platform?** "Movie Show Investing and The AYeList are both run by AYe Producer, Inc. The AYeList is our distribution channel, with on-demand streaming and automated revenue splits."
5. **How are my ideas protected?** Share loglines and synopses, not full scripts; consider registering with the U.S. Copyright Office or the WGA registry.

Admin, scope, and launch

Admin is password-protected, organized into tables, and every table exports to CSV.

Admin section	What it shows
Summary	Filmmakers, projects, showcased; investors, confirmed pledges; total pledged (to projects vs unallocated); average pledge; accredited count and dollars
Pledges by project	Project, slate, offer per \$100, confirmed pledgers, total, accredited, top city
By location	State, city, investors, pledged total, filmmakers
Funnels	Each screen or page, people who reached it, drop-off % (filmmaker and investor)
Market	Per slate: filmmaker offers vs investor minimums, "wants lower" count, and where they overlap
Price test	Distribution group A vs B: started, completed, deal answers, offers chosen
Queues	Approvals, calls (accredited first), unanswered questions
Messages	Project, investor, question, answer, asked, response time, reported; hide button
Channels	Sign-ups by utm_source and referral code
Email log	To, type, status

Scope lock

- **In:** home, slates page, filmmaker flow, investor flow, project pages, Explore with matching, result/share/showcase screens, Ask the filmmaker, verified badges, private filmmaker and lineup pages, Find my lineup, confirmation emails, admin.
- **Out:** payments, banking, escrow, Greenlights, leaderboards, lineup editing, public Q&A, direct messages, tiered rates.

Stack

React (Vite) + Tailwind · Flask + Replit Postgres · Bunny Stream (video) and Bunny Storage + CDN (images) · Mailjet (email) · Firebase Auth (email-link sign-in, phone verification) · Mixpanel + Clarity · Cloudflare Turnstile · Replit Deployments.

Guardrails

- All pledges non-binding; no money collected; securities notice, disclaimers, and footer on every page.
- The confirmation email is a "Pledge confirmation (non-binding)," never a contract.
- Privacy policy names AYe Producer, Inc. and says messages may be reviewed for safety.
- Paid UGC uses #ad disclosure; no referral rewards.

Questions for your securities attorney

1. Can Movie Show Investing collect non-binding pledges for multiple filmmakers' future offerings?
2. What exact notice wording is required on pledge pages, share cards, and emails?
3. Do matching and per-project offers create broker or adviser issues?

Launch order

1. Filmmaker side goes live first, two to three weeks ahead, so Explore has real projects.
2. Investor side opens once Explore has approved projects.
3. Market through Q4; review numbers weekly.
4. Take the data to boutique firms and distributors (Tests 4 and 5).

Still to decide

- ☐ Pass line for each test
- ☐ Confirm Idea Slate sizes (\$50K feature, \$65K series)
- ☐ Later: when the platform gets paid (proportionally or last)
- ☐ Later: better rates for bigger pledges